

2. Check the user input.
3. If the input is valid {
 - fetch stories
 - display stories }
- else {
 - show user the start menu }

And the script is as follows:

```
<?php
require_once "digclass.php"; // include the api
$diggobj = new diggclass(); // create the object
// we would limit our bot to serving stories from these topics only
$topic = array('1' => 'Technology', '2' => 'Lifestyle', '3' =>
'Entertainment', '4' => 'Gaming', '5' => 'Sports', '6' => 'Science', '7' => 'World &
Business', '8' => 'Offbeat', '9' => '');

$choice = $_REQUEST['msg']; // get the user input
$choice = $choice + 0; // convert choice to a number

// if the choice was not between 1 and 9 show user the Menu
if(($choice > 9) || ($choice < 1)){
    echo "Type in the topic number\n<br>
        1 Technology \n<br>
        2 Lifestyle \n<br>
        3 Entertainment \n<br>
        4 Gaming \n<br>
        5 Sports \n<br>
        6 Science \n<br>
        7 World & Business\n<br>
        8 Offbeat \n<br>
        9 All \n<br>";
    return;
}

echo("Top 10 $topic[$choice] Stories");
// fetch top stories, 10 is default, 3 indicates popular stories
$results = $diggobj->getStories("3","$topic[$choice]");
// iterate over each story
for($i=0;$i<count($results);$i++){
    $desc = $results[$i]['description'];
    $link = $results[$i]['link'];
    // display the description followed by the corresponding link
    echo("[ $i + 1] $desc $link");
    echo("\n<br><br>");
}
```

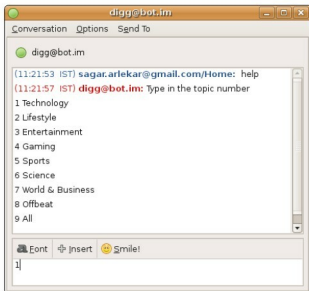


Figure 1: The IM bot at work

?>

Some interesting ideas that you can try for IM bots are listed below. You will have to hunt for the appropriate APIs or build the service yourself to implement these.

1. Dictionary and translation bot.
 2. IMDB movie information bot—The user types in the movie name and the bot will return the cast, the synopsis, ratings and related information.
 3. Movie showtime bot—The user can type in the city and the movie name, and the bot will return the show timings.
 4. SMS bot—Typing on the tiny cell phone keypad is a pain. This bot can take in the text message with the recipient's name and deliver it.
- So, aren't toys fun? 

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